enterprise on which global trade depended. Ships were assigned classes and were to conform to certain norms to maintain them. The published registers of classification societies listed all ships classed by that society, and provided details about construction, tonnage and capacity, dimensions and even details of engines and boilers.[62] Lloyd's Register of Shipping, even more thorough and wide-ranging than Bureau Veritas, also maintained the *Shipping & Mercantile Gazette* and *Lloyd's List* which kept track of ships' voyages. *Lloyd's Captains Register* listed certified captains and mates and attendant details of their qualification and experience. The ship and engineer surveyors of Lloyd's Register of Shipping in India were located at Bombay, Calcutta and Colombo with local agents filing intelligence from the smaller ports. The *Gallia* was surveyed in Colombo where one H.B. Ratsey was the surveyor while the *Lawoe* was surveyed in Bombay.[63]

The *Gallia* (Figure 8) was a steel twin screw steamer of 1305 gross (555 net) tons with an underdeck of 1,136. Registered at Colombo, it flew the British flag. Built in 1904 by Compagnie Francaise de Navigation et de Construction Navale, in Nantes, France it measured 260.7 (length) x 28.5 (breadth) x 16.2 (depth) feet. Originally owned by its builders and Satre Reunis it was sold to Compagnie Méditerranéene de Navigation from whom SSNCo bought it.[64]